Team Up!

Meet People First. Build Teams Together.

A mobile-supported experience for discovering potential teammates through face-to-face interaction.

THE PROBLEM

Finding teammates shouldn't start with awkward silence. Forming teams with unfamiliar classmates can be challenging. Students may struggle to approach others, start conversations, or understand whether they would work well together.

Traditional team formation often provides limited opportunities for students to get to know each other before making a decision.
This creates a design opportunity to make team formation more socially engaging, comfortable, and informed.

OUR DESIGN OPPORTUNITY

How might we help students to feel less pressured and more comfortable to form a team with new people?

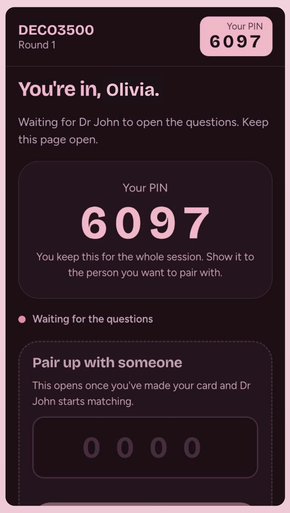
Rather than relying only on profiles or automated matching, we explore how mobile technology can encourage conversations and support students in making their own team choices.

HOW TEAM UP WORKS

Student Experience

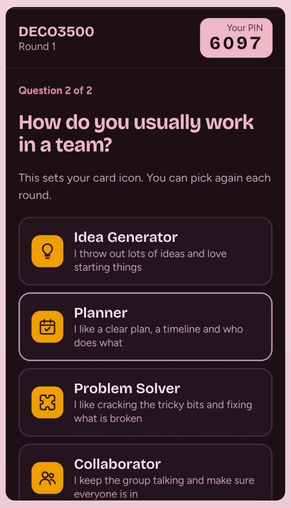
1. Join & Connect

Meet another student and exchange PINs to establish a connection.



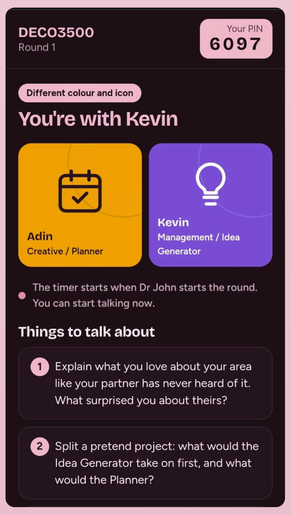
2. Personalise

Select personal interests or working preferences.



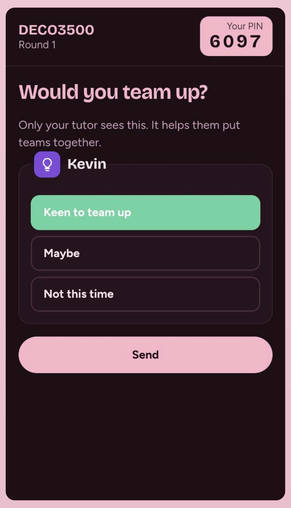
3. Start a Conversation

Use guided questions to explore shared interests, working styles, and expectations.



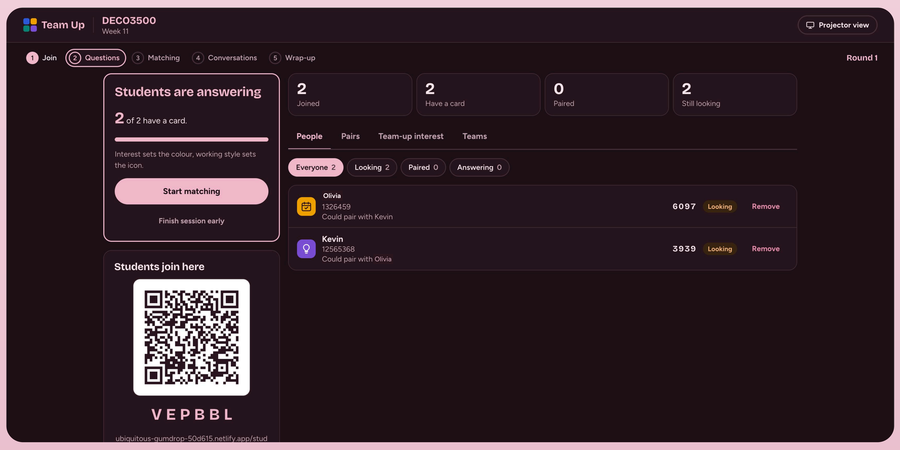
4. Express Interest

Privately choose whether you would like to work with the person.



Tutor Experience

The tutor dashboard supports session setup, student participation, interaction monitoring, mutual-interest visibility, and team formation.



WHAT MAKES TEAM UP SOCIAL?

Conversation as Interaction

Guided prompts encourage students to communicate beyond basic introductions.

Student Agency

Students explore potential teammates and privately express their preferences instead of relying entirely on automated matching.

Tutor-Facilitated Coordination

The tutor coordinates the session and supports team formation using information from student interactions.

DESIGN PROCESS

Early Prototype

Picture and text-based clues encouraged interaction but sometimes caused confusion and pressure to commit.

Refined Prototype

Personal preferences, conversation prompts, and private interest feedback support more comfortable interactions.

KEY EVALUATION FINDINGS

Guided prompts help break the ice

Interests provide common ground

PIN exchange can cause confusion

Repeated prompts feel repetitive

Conversation prompts helped participants initiate discussions.

Connection instructions and repeated questions revealed opportunities for improvement.

LIMITATIONS & FUTURE WORK

Due to time constraints, the prototype was not tested with complete strangers. As conversational behaviour can differ between familiar and unfamiliar individuals, this may limit the validity of our findings.

The same participants were involved across testing sessions, potentially introducing practice and carry-over effects that may influence their feedback and interactions.

Future Work
Future evaluations should involve unfamiliar students and new participant groups in a real classroom setting to better assess social engagement, usability, and the overall team formation experience.

DECO3500 | Team 26

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